

Analysis of Five Recent DDoS Attacks

1. Cloudflare mitigation of record 7.3 Tbps DDoS (2025)

Target: A single IP address (victim not publicly named).

Technology used: UDP-based volumetric amplification/reflection techniques and large botnets producing a peak of 7.3 Tbps (37.4 TB in 45 seconds).

Attacker's motive: Likely testing capabilities or demonstrating brute-force capacity; commercial extortion or reconnaissance are common motives in similar events.

Overall impact: Short-duration but extremely high-volume spike aimed at overwhelming infrastructure; Cloudflare mitigated the attack without public customer-impact reports.

Defensive strategies:

- Upstream scrubbing and large-scale DDoS scrubbing services (e.g., Cloudflare/Arbor).
- Properly configured UDP reflection mitigations (rate-limiting, BCP 38 source-address validation to limit IP spoofing).
- Anycast distribution and capacity overprovisioning; monitoring and automated DDoS playbooks.

Sources:

- Tom's Hardware (Cloudflare blocks 7.3 Tbps attack)

2. Microsoft Azure / Microsoft 365 outage linked to DDoS (July 31, 2024)

Target: Azure portal and certain Microsoft 365 services.

Technology used: Large-scale DDoS producing usage spikes; mitigation systems (Azure Front Door, CDN) experienced strain and misconfiguration contributed to prolonged impact.

Attacker's motive: Unclear; many high-volume DDoS incidents are either criminal (ransom) or opportunistic tests.

Overall impact: Several hours of intermittent errors and timeouts affecting enterprise customers, disruptions to cloud services.

Defensive strategies:

- Hardened CDN and WAF configurations; failover plans for management/control planes.
- Comprehensive incident response runbooks and post-incident validation of mitigation rules to prevent 'defense errors'.
- DDoS scrubbing with multiple providers for redundancy.

Sources:

- Cybersecurity Dive (Microsoft confirms Azure, 365 outage linked to DDoS)

3. X (formerly Twitter) DDoS disruption (March 2025)

Target: X/Twitter platform leading to global outages.

Technology used: Large coordinated request floods; reports mentioned IP addresses traced to Ukraine and claims by a group called 'Dark Storm'.

Attacker's motive: Could be hacktivism, political signaling, or to cause reputational harm.

Overall impact: Significant global outages for a major social platform, degraded user experience, and potential loss of ad revenue.

Defensive strategies:

- Distributed ingress filtering and rate-limiting at edge.
- Use of anycast, autoscaling, and multiple-layered CDN protections.
- Rapid attribution and legal coordination to deter politically-motivated actors.

Sources:

- SOC Radar (Major cyber-attacks review - X DDoS)

4. Aisuru botnet suspected multi-terabit attacks affecting gaming platforms (Sep-Oct 2025)

Target: Gaming platforms and services (Steam, Riot Games, Epic Games, etc.).

Technology used: Aisuru botnet produced multi-terabit volumetric attacks (reports of peaks and widescale disruptions), likely leveraging compromised IoT devices and amplification vectors.

Attacker's motive: Could include ransom DDoS, proving botnet capability, or disruptive actions against gaming services.

Overall impact: Widespread outages across popular gaming networks, affecting millions of users and creating high-profile service disruptions.

Defensive strategies:

- Engage cloud DDoS mitigation vendors with massive capacity.
- Harden infrastructures with traffic filtering, rate limits, and geo-blocking where appropriate.
- Incident playbooks and customer communication strategies to reduce secondary impact.

Sources:

- FastNetMon (Aisuru botnet suspected), PC Gamer, various news sources

5. 'Operation Sindoor' — high volume attacks reported against NSE (India) (recent)

Target: National Stock Exchange (NSE), India.

Technology used: Extremely high volume of automated attacks reported (news referenced '40 crore' attacks in a single day); while the article focuses on 'cyberattacks' the patterns suggest large-scale probing and potentially DDoS-style volumetric/connection floods.

Attacker's motive: Could be to probe resilience of critical financial infrastructure or attempt disruption; motives often vary from political to financially-motivated reconnaissance.

Overall impact: Elevated alert level, mitigation efforts by NSE cyber teams; potential risk to trading operations if left unmanaged.

Defensive strategies:

- Critical infrastructure must use dedicated scrubbing centers, segregated networks for trading/management interfaces, and redundant connectivity.
- Proactive threat hunting, collaboration with national CERTs, and traffic anomaly detection.

Sources:

- Times of India (Operation Sindoor report)